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Files show thin case for arrest of Öztürk

Judge releases records detailing investigation

By **Tonya Alanez, Giulia McDonnell Nieto del Rio, and Shelley Murphy**

GLOBE STAFF

Newly released documents show how Trump administration officials internally had acknowledged they could not find any evidence Tufts graduate student Rümeysa Öztürk was involved in antisemitic behavior or supported terrorist organizations, yet arrested her without warning and publicly branded her a national security threat.

In March, US State Department officials wrote in an “action memo” the Turkish national “has been involved with actions protesting Tufts’ relationship with Israel,” referring to an op-ed she coauthored in the campus newspaper a year earlier in support of Palestinians.

But, an analysis of Öztürk’s activities by the Department of Homeland Security has not “provided any evidence showing that Öztürk engaged in any antisemitic activity or made any public statements indicating support for a terrorist organization or antisemitism generally,” according to the memo.

Homeland Security also “did not identify any alternative grounds of removability” that

STUDENTS, Page A6

Protesters in Maine demand ICE leave

By **Giulia McDonnell Nieto del Rio, Sabrina Shankman, and Danny McDonald**

GLOBE STAFF

PORTLAND, Maine — Hundreds of protesters gathered here Friday in the largest demonstration since a federal immigration sweep began in Maine earlier this week, decrying the ongoing operation as cruel and illegal, while widespread fear continued to paralyze communities across the state, bringing some aspects of daily life to a halt.

On a frigid evening, a crowd nearing an estimated 1,000 people demonstrated at the rally in Portland’s Monument Square before marching through the streets. The energy from the crowd — bundled in hats, scarves, and gloves — was reverberating throughout the city.

“People are afraid,” Portland City Councilor Pious Ali told the Globe after leaving a mosque following a Friday prayer service in the city’s Bayside neighborhood.

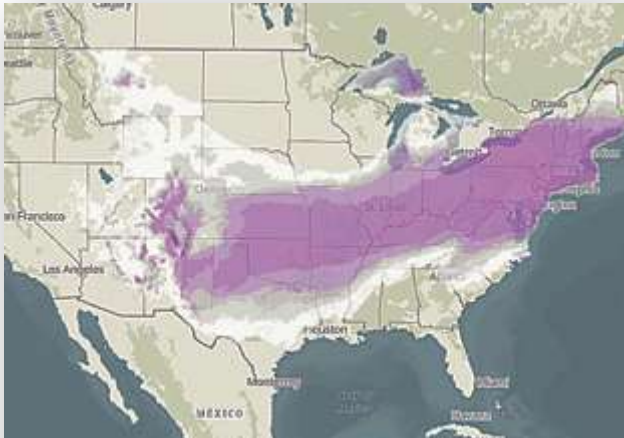
MAINE, Page A6

A storm for the ages



KIICHIRO SATO/ASSOCIATED PRESS

People walked on an ice-covered beach along the shore of Lake Michigan Friday in Chicago.



ASSOCIATED PRESS

The wide world of winter

A huge part of the US faces a powerful mix of deep cold, high winds, and piles of snow this weekend. Forecasts for the Boston area include:

Friday's low temperature	Wind chill on Saturday	Peak snow total
3°	-10°	22"

New England — and the nation — prepare for wind, cold, snow

By **Ken Mahan and John R. Ellement**

GLOBE STAFF

A behemoth of a storm system thousands of miles wide and stretching across three time zones is headed to New England on Sunday, expected to dump as much as 2 feet of snow in parts during one of the deepest cold spells of the season.

It will be the most significant winter storm in the region in four years, a hunker-down, stay-off-the-roads event in which “travel will be difficult to impossible,” according to the National Weather Service in Boston.

With dangerously cold Arctic air already rushing in, intense rounds of snow will hit mainly Massachusetts, Rhode Island, and Connecticut Sunday afternoon and night before tapering off sometime Monday

afternoon.

Already in the depths of winter, New Englanders will experience temperatures as much as 30 degrees below normal. Wind chills are expected to drop as low as 10

► **More than half of US is in storm's path. A2.**
► **How to stay safe in the frigid cold. B5.**

degrees below zero in the Boston area Friday night into Saturday, while in Vermont that number could hit 20 to 40 degrees below zero on Saturday morning.

Frostbite will be a concern for anyone outside with exposed skin for more than 30 minutes.

Officials are warning residents to stay inside and, when venturing outdoors, to layer up. In Massachusetts, to layer up. In Massachusetts, to layer up. In Massachusetts, to layer up.

STORM, Page A10

As Idowu is out, Wu has chance to reset economic development focus

Mayor says city can support both neighborhoods and downtown

By **Niki Griswold and Janelle Nanos**

GLOBE STAFF

When Michelle Wu became mayor in 2021, she quickly tapped Segun Idowu to fill a key post in her administration: head of economic development. But she didn’t want him to

do the job quite the way it had always been done.

Rather, she asked Idowu — at the time the president of the Black Economic Council of Massachusetts — to make equity a core principle of the city’s approach to business development, and to focus on support-

ing neighborhood business districts and diverse entrepreneurs, not just the big employers downtown. She even changed the job’s title to chief of economic opportunity and inclusion.

For four years, Idowu did just that, launching new grant programs for local businesses, doling out liquor licenses in parts of town that have few, and connecting far-flung commer-

cial districts to the resources of City Hall. Then, Monday, Idowu announced he will step down at the end of February, to care for his elderly grandmother.

Idowu’s departure comes at a precarious time for Boston’s economy, amid threats to some of the city’s core industries, concerns over the vitality of the Financial District, and declining values of commercial real estate that powers the city’s

budget. Now, business leaders are wondering: Will Wu, and whoever she picks to succeed Idowu, continue the neighborhood-focused approach to economic development, or will they pivot to prioritize a downtown that’s still struggling to rebound from the COVID-19 pandemic?

It’s a push-and-pull faced by Boston mayors for decades, to layer up. In Massachusetts, to layer up. In Massachusetts, to layer up.

IDOWU, Page A10



CHARLES KRUPA/ASSOCIATED PRESS

ON THEIR GAME

Patriots head coach Mike Vrabel took questions Friday at Gillette Stadium. When New England faces the Broncos Sunday for the AFC Championship, brothers Christian (New England) and Jonah Elliss (Denver) will be playing against one another in an NFL game for the first time. **C1.**

President Trump said a large naval force was heading to Iran, continuing his threats of US military action against the government nearly a month after protests erupted there. **A3.**

About 100 clergy were arrested during a protest against deportation flights at Minneapolis-Saint Paul International Air-

port, as an economic protest of the Trump administration’s immigration operations in Minnesota shuttered hundreds of businesses. **A2.**

The Massachusetts Department of Public Health is the latest state agency to significantly scale back its downtown office space. **D1.**

Going for the cold

Saturday: Sunny, cold. High: 13-18. Low: 6-11.

Sunday: Snow later. High: 20-25. Low: 15-20.

High tide: 2:37 a.m. 2:57 p.m.

Sunrise: 7:05 Sunset: 4:48

Comics and Weather, **D4-5.** Obituaries, **C9.**

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